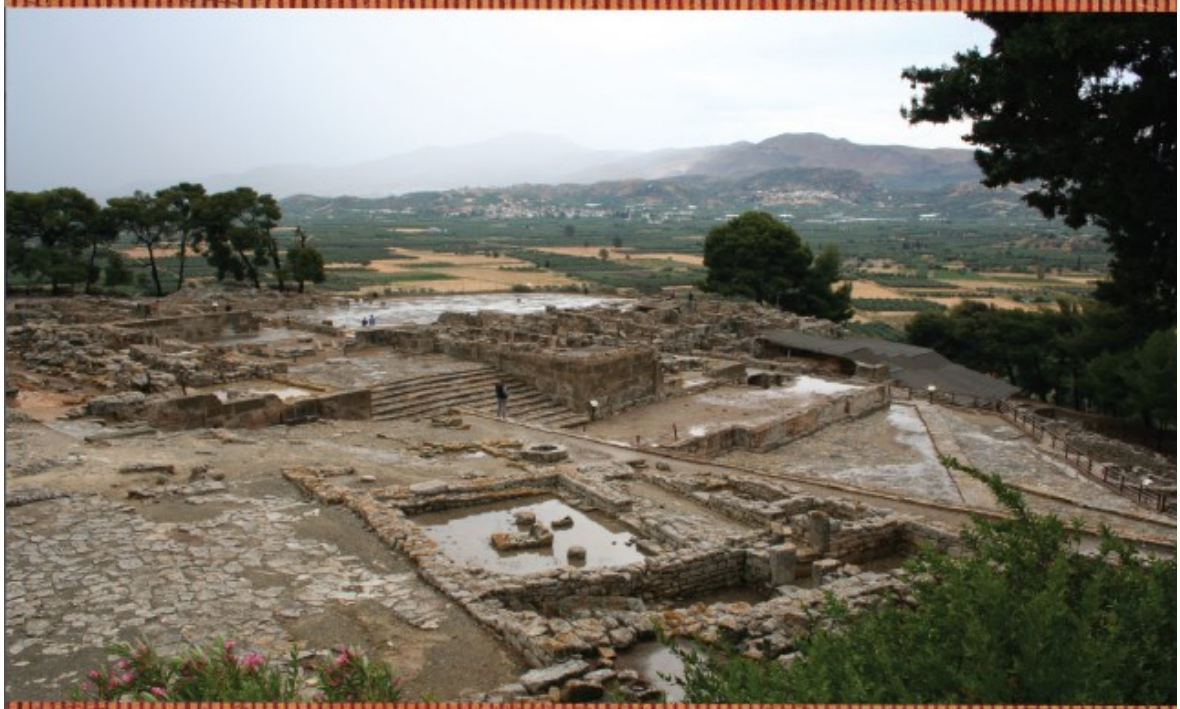
VOLUME I PART II

The Decipherment of Minoan Linear A

Hurrians and Hurrian in Minoan Crete
Text and summary



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Peter G. van Soesbergen (born in Amsterdam, 7th February 1945) studied Classics at the University of Amsterdam (Doctoral Examination *cum laude*). He pursued research on *The archaeological context of Minoan Linear A* for *The Netherlands Organization for Pure Research* (report of 400 pp.), published several articles and gave papers at international colloquia and congresses (Heraklion, Bucharest, Sheffield, Nottingham, Prague, Rome, Naples), a Mycenaean Seminar on *The historical significance of onomastic data from Linear A and B texts* (Institute of Classical Studies, University of London) and special papers on Linear A at Cambridge and Groningen. He pursued research as a Leverhulme European Visiting Fellow and Independent Research Worker at the University of Sheffield, where he received the degree of Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) on the thesis *The onomastics of the 'Minoan Linear A' and 'Linear B' documents and their historical significance.*

THE DECIPHERMENT OF MINOAN LINEAR A - VOLUME I - PART II

The author shows that the Holy Trinity of the main Hurrian Gods, *Tešub*, *Ḫebat* and their son *Šarruma* is addressed in a sophisticated and poetic way, usually at the beginning of the so-called 'libation formulas', by means of descriptive epithets. They appear in a fixed order of importance. First Tešub's Linear A epithet *a-ta-i-jo-wa-ja* 'Our Father', absolutive/vocative *attai=(j)=o/uwwa=(j)=aš*, consisting of *attai* 'father' + transitional semi-vowel *-j-* between 2 vowels + enclitic possessive pronoun 1st person sing. *-o/uwwa-* (my) + transitional semi-vowel *-j-* between 2 vowels + the pluralizer *-aš* (our). Compare cuneiform Hurrian *ᵈTe-e-eš-šu-pa-aš …….. eb-ri-iw-wa-šu-uš at-ta-iw-wa-šu-uš* (3 *ergatives*), 'Tešub …. Our Lord, Our Father' in the Tušratta letter (Mit. IV 118).

Then the epithet of *Tešub*'s wife *Ḫebat*, *a-di-<da->ki-ti/e(-te)*, analysis *ašdi-dagitti*, 'The woman is a beauty / beautiful'> 'The (most) beautiful woman', appears (in haplography) in the libation formulas. The form is attested as *a-di-da-ki-ti* (KN Zc 6.2) in *scriptio plena* on the interior of a Middle-Minoan III cup at Knossos (*ašdi* = 'woman'). [In Linear A and B *-s-* preceding an occlusive is not expressed in consonant clusters.]

Then the epithet of the young god *Šarrum(m)a* appears as *a-sa-sa-ra-me*, analysis *arša-šarr=a=me*, 'The young man/boy, he is like the King of Gods'. The Linear A variant *ja-sa-sa-ra-ma|-na* (KN Za 10a-b) can be analysed as *y(a)/y(e)-arša-šarr=a=mann=a*, 'as well as "The young boy (*arša* 'young man') is (*mann=(i)a*) like the King of Gods" ', (*šarr=a* is the *essive* of Hurrian *šarr=i* 'King of Gods').

The contents of the prayers in the 'libation formulas' appear to be about the same subject as the meaning of many personal names, in which the *birth of healthy children*, sometimes after the death of an older child, is always in the minds of the parents. Linear A *u-na-ka-na-si*, Hurrian *un=a-ḷi(ḷ)an=a=ššši* 'come childhood, childbirth' is an essential term occurring in almost every formula. It may not be accidental that the name *Arkhanes* is attested as *a]-ka-ne* (AK 3a.1+fr. AK.1b.1, join P.G. van Soesbergen) on a Linear A tablet found in the Minoan Villa of *Epano Arkhanes*. Even more significant is the fact that the toponym can be analysed as Hurrian *ar=ḷane/i* 'Give a child' and that the Villa of Arkhanes may well have been the starting point for supplicants and priests to go upto the Peak Sanctuary of Mount Ioukhtas to pray to *Tešub, Ḫebat and Šarru(m)ma.*

In an inscription from Mount Ioukhtas a variant of *eni attanni* 'God the Father' is mentioned: *i-na-ta-i-do-di-si-ka* (IO Za 6), analysis *en(i) / in(i)* 'God' + *atta* 'Father' + *id=u/od=i-šikka* 'do not strike your thunderbolt !' (all notions joined in one sequence). The Old Hurrian negation *-u/od-* shows that the inscription is Old Hurrian. The inscription *u]-na-pi-da-da-[* (IO Za 11.1) from Ioukhtas, Hurrian *un=a=b Ida=da(n)* 'He/She (a god/ priest) comes/came to (Mount) Ida (+ directive *-da*) or from Ida (+ ablative *-dan*), is also Old Hurrian, for *-b* in *un=a=b* is the Old Hurrian marker of the subject 3rd person sing. In the next line the Holy Trinity appears as *i-na-i-da-nui* (IO Za 11.2) 'Gods of Ida'.

See for an extensive analysis *Chapter 11: 'Religious' Linear A inscriptions*.

Hurrians and Hurrian in Minoan Crete: Text and summary

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VOLUME I, PART II: TEXT AND SUMMARY

by

Peter George van Soesbergen

INGRAMSPARK

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and in remembrance of
Anna M. van Soesbergen-Jurriaans
and Petrus J. van Soesbergen

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THE MAIN LINEAR A PHONETIC SIGNS (ARRANGED ACCORDING TO THE LINEAR B SYLLABARY)

THE MAIN LINEAR A PHONETIC SIGNS SHOWN WITH THE HURRIAN CUNEIFORM PHONETIC VALUES

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CHAPTER 13
LINEAR A: ONOMASTICA AND LEXICA

Studying the Linear A texts from the archives of Minoan palaces, farmhouses and villas one thing one cannot fail to observe is the fact that normal lexical terms are extremely rare. We encounter so-called transaction terms such as ***ku-ro*** and ***po-to-ku-ro***, ***ki-ro*** (also abbreviated to ***ki***) and ***te***, possibly an abbreviation for ***te+ro*** (HT 104.1). I may add to the repertory very frequent ***sa-ra₂***.

Names of commodities are extremely rare in Linear A, even more than in Linear B, because the Minoan scribes used very small page tablets and even smaller nodules, sealings and roundels to keep their records with a kind of shorthand writing that went far beyond what their Mycenaean colleagues were later willing to accept. The Minoan scribes used apart from the normal sequences all sorts of ligatures (in my transliterations rendered with + signs instead of the normal hyphens), but most of all ideograms of men, armed men, women, sheep, goats, oxen, pigs, a great variety of agricultural commodities, arms, among which shields, helmets, cuirasses, lances and chariots, parts of chariots and wheels and tools. Most inventive I consider the ideogram of a *cloud* with the addition of syllabic sign ***pi***, that I describe as NUBES+***pi*** (HT 33.4) and explain as ***Tešup=pi*** 'of Tešub'.

As a result most of the information we receive from the tablets consists of onomastic material, mainly personal names, but also recognizable toponyms and ethnics. One great advantage of Hurrian personal names is that they do not only reveal their clearly Hurrian identity, but that they are themselves complete grammatical formations, whether they are so-called *verbal* or *nominal* 'sentence names' or so-called 'one-word names'. They show that the people registered on the tablets were Hurrian, that they worshipped Hurrian gods and heroes, that they lived in places with Hurrian names, that they used ethnics with Hurrian suffixes and that their vernacular was Hurrian.

I start with a special text that was first published as APPENDIX 2 to the 2016 edition of *MINOAN LINEAR A*, Vol. I, Part II: Linear A ***po-to-ku-ro*** (HT 122b.6; HT 131b.4) : Hurrian ***puttu(-)kuru***.[1] I had chosen to use *Appendices* as an easy solution for the publication of some new identifications and interpretations accomplished after completion of the *indices*. In this way I could avoid altering the order of pages of the original text corresponding with the indices. As a result of my decision to publish a new revised and extended edition it is now possible to incorporate the *Appendices* into the text of this revised edition. My interpretation of Linear A ***po-to-ku-ro*** (HT 122b.6; HT 131b.4) as Hurrian ***puttu(-)kuru*** has led to inclusion into this Chapter.

For the readers convenience I include the texts of the tablets HT 122 and HT 131 from Hagia Triada. For full annotations, bibliographical details and for the *analysed structure* of the texts I refer to my *Corpus of transliterated Linear A texts*.

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[1] Passages on Linear A *ku-ro* in the Chapter on 'Script and language' (*Minoan Linear A*, Vol I, Part I) are partly repeated in this Chapter, since the discussion on *ku-ro* is closely connected with that on *po-to-ku-ro*.

Starting from A. Kober's observation that Linear A and Linear B employed different words for 'total' in a consistent manner, P. Meriggi pointed out that summations were always preceded by two syllabic signs in Linear A. If these were transliterated with the Ventris's values of their Linear B counterparts, the result would be either ***ku-ro*** or ***ku-lo***, which could represent the common Semitic root ***kl*** meaning 'all'.[2]

The challenge was soon accepted by C.H. Gordon in two articles.[3] He integrated his results into a monograph *Evidence for the Minoan language*, Ventnor, N.J. 1966, in which he changed his allegiance from Akkadian to West Semitic, Phoenician in particular, and compared ***ku-ro*** with Semitic ***kull-*** (e.g. Hebrew כל *kl*) 'all'.[4] Identification of Linear A ***ku-ro*** or ***ku-lo*** with Semitic ***kl*** by P. Meriggi and subsequently by C.H. Gordon seemed attractive on semantic grounds, but Gordon's approach was soon met with criticism, because terms like ***ku-ro*** seem to defy definite conclusions as to the character of the idiom written with Linear A, since the term may be a loan-word just as the English word 'total' is derived from Latin ***totus*** 'entire' [through Middle English, from Old French, from medieval Latin ***totalis***].

E.J.Furnée has offered another etymology for Linear A ***ku-ro***: "Das einzige Wort aus Linear A, dessen Lesung und Bedeutung hundertprozentig sicher erscheinen, nämlich ***ku-ro*** 'Summe', könnte m.E. genauso gut – oder vielleicht sogar besser als bislang geschehen ist [Here he refers to Meriggi, Gordon and Georgiev] – aus dem Vorgriechischen gedeutet werden, wenn man nämlich annimmt, dass ***ku-ro*** für **kuro* steht und auf **kuu̯ro-* zurückgeht. Dies könnte dann einen Nebenform von ****kupro-*** sein (vgl. die Hesychglosse *κύπρος* = *κεφάλαιον ἀριθμοῦ*, mit einem im Vorgriechischen nicht ungebräuchlichen Wechsel von ***p*** und ***u̯***. Ich lasse diese Deutung von ***ku-ro*** dahingestellt sein; jedenfalls ist das dem Wort ***κύπρος*** zugrunde liegende vorindogermanische Element ****kup-*** (**kub-*), 'Kopf' für Kreta bezeugt, und zwar in aspirierter Form, vgl. *κύφερον ἢ κυφήν· κεφαλήν. Κρῆτες* (H)." [5]

However, there appears to be one flaw in Furnée's argumentation, since he does not explain how the phonetic development from **kuu̯ro-*/**kupro-* > *kuro* could have been completed in the much earlier Linear A form, whereas in the later form *κύπρος* in the gloss of Hesychius of Alexandria the **/*p*/** or **/*w*/** was still fully intact. This is a decisive issue, since an occlusive **/*p*/** was always expressed in consonant clusters and a non-occlusive **/*w*/** preceding sonantic consonants was also expressed in consonant clusters in Linear A and B.

Another etymology for Linear A *ku-ro* was presented by R. Gordesiani: "*Ku-ro* – 'Summe', einziges wort aus Linear A, dessen Lesung and Deutung wir, wie M. Pope bemerkt, für ganz sicher halten konnen. Vgl. georg. *ḳr-* 'sammeln', das in dem Verbalstamm *ḳreb/ḳrib* 'sammeln' (megr. *ḳorob*, tschan. *ḳo(r)ob*) bezeugt ist. Dieser Stamm geht seinerseits auf kartw. *ḳar-/ ḳr-* 'verbinden, verknüpfen, zusammenfügen' zurück." [6]

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[2] P. Meriggi, *Primi Elementi di Minoico A* (Minos Suppl.), Salamanca 1956.

[3] C.H. Gordon, 'Notes on Minoan Linear A', *Antiquity 31 (1957)*, 120-130; 'Akkadian tablets in Minoan dress', *Antiquity 31 (1957)*, 237-240.

[4] C.H. Gordon, *Evidence for the Minoan language*, Ventnor, N.J. 1966, 27, sub 117.

[5] *E.J.Furnée, Die wichtigsten konsonantischen Erscheinungen des Vorgriechischen*, The Hague, Paris 1972, 396.

[6] R. Gordesiani, Zu den kaukasisch-ägäischen Beziehungen im II. Jahrtausend v.u.Z.', *Actes du VIIe congrès de la F.I.E.C.*, *Vol.II*, Budapest 1983, 509.

E. Peruzzi had previously argued in favour of an Indo-European connection. He accepted some of L.R. Palmer's suggestions regarding a possible Luwian interpretation.

He also maintained that morphological evidence for noun declension, meagre though it was, might indicate Greek as the language of the texts. For the Linear A word for 'total' ***ku-ro***, read with Linear B phonetic values, he proposed an Indo-European etymology ****ger-*** 'to collect' (cf. Greek ***ἀγείρω***). For the word that was explained as 'deficit', Linear A ***ki-ro***, he suggested an Indo-European root ****(s)kel-*** 'due', 'owing' (cf. Lithuanian ***skeliu***). Though the evidence was put forward in a comprehensive way, one must conclude that it is too thin. For further criticism of Peruzzi's proposals I may refer to M. Pope's *Aegean writing and Linear A* (SIMA 8), Lund 1964, 6.[7]

In *The historical significance of onomastic data from Linear A and B texts* (Mycenaean Seminar, Institute of Classical Studies, University of London, 28th May 1980, 4) I have explained that Hurrian ***kuru***, which should phonologically be understood as /***kuro***/, not only provides the exact phonetic equivalent to the Linear A word, but could also be a likely candidate from a semantic point of view. It certainly is one of the most frequent terms in the Tušratta letter. [8] The Hurrian word means 'again'.

E. Laroche, *Glossaire de la langue hourrite*, 156, s.v. ***guru*** 'de nouveau, encore'. "Sens déduit des contextes par Messerschmidt, *Mit. St.*, 26; selon Speiser, *IH,* 71, 91, nom adverbialisé." He gives the examples: ***gu-ru***, Mit. III 15, 39, 55, 93, etc. and *gu-ru-ú-we*, *ib.* IV 42, and *gu-ru-u-u*[, *ib.* I, 45.[9]

E.A. Speiser, *IH*, 91: "***kuru*** 'again, in return': cf. Mit. III 15, 39, 55, etc. The approximate meaning of this adverbial concept has been known since the beginning of Hurrian studies. The word functions as an independent particle when it is not followed by suffixes. The adverbial connotation helps to explain nominal and verbal uses of the root in the sense of 'return'." Cf. also I.M. Diakonoff, *Hurrisch und Urartäisch,* Munich 1971, 147: ***kuru/o*** 'wieder', vgl. ***kur-*** 'zurückkehren'.[10]

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[7] E. Peruzzi, *Le Iscrizioni Minoiche* (Atti dell' Accademia Toscana di Scienze e Lettere 24), Florence 1960, 32-128.

[8] F.W. Bush, *A grammar of the Hurrian language* (Brandeis University dissertation, Univ. Microfilms Inc.), Ann Arbor 1964, 239-240, sub 'particles exhibiting *-u/-o* stems'. E.A. Speiser, *Introduction to Hurrian*, *Annual of the American Schools of Oriental research 20 (1940-1941)*, New Haven 1941, 71, 73, 87-88, 91, 183-184, 214.

[9] E. Laroche, *Glossaire de la langue hourrite*, *Première partie* (A-L), *RHA 34 (1976)*, Paris 1978 and E. Laroche, *Glossaire de la langue hourrite*, *deuxième partie* (M-Z, Index), *RHA 35 (1977)*, Paris 1979 (reprint Paris 1980), 156.

[10] Cf. F.W. Bush, The relationship between the Hurrian suffixes *-ne/-na* and *-nni/e /-nna*, in: H.A. Hoffner Jr. (ed.), *Orient and Occident. Essays presented to Cyrus H. Gordon on the occasion of his sixty-fifth birthday* (AOAT 22), Kevelaer/Neukirchen -Vluyn 1973, 51[91]: 'furthermore'.
Cf. M. Dietrich – W. Mayer, Beiträge zum Hurritischen (I), *Ugarit Forschungen 23 (1991)*, 107-126 (especially 116): 'weiter'. Cf. M. Dietrich – W. Mayer, Beiträge zum Hurritischen (II). Die Konjunctive in Mitanni-Hurritischen, *UF 24 (1992)*, 39-58 (esp. 47): 'weiter'. Cf. I. Wegner, *Einführung in die hurritische Sprache*, Wiesbaden 2007[2], 264: 'wieder, wiederum, fernerhin'.

Semantically the usage of Hurrian /***kuro***/ 'again, in return' can be explained from the mechanism of the scribe's action of counting the numbers just written on the Linear A tablets and recording them *again* in the summation at the bottom, in the sense of: (here are the numbers) *again*, that is in total. The scribes needed a short word that could serve their purpose as the Linear B scribes used ***to-so*** and ***to-sa*** meaning 'so much / so many', which could in the context be perceived as 'so much / so many in total'.

C.H. Gordon offered not only a West Semitic interpretation of Linear A ***ku-ro***, but also of ***po-to-ku-ro***: "HT 122 has a total of 31 (***ku-ro*** 31) on the obverse, and another total of 65 (***ku-ro*** 65) on the reverse. The two totals are combined to form ***po-to-ku-ro*** 96 'grandtotal: 96' (Plate VIII). The meaning 'grandtotal' is fixed by context, but it remains to explain the first element ***po-to***. We know that the word for 'son' was pronounced ***bun-*** in Ugaritic. The feminine ****bunt-*** would become ***butt-*** (with ***nt*** > ***tt***). Tentatively we suggest that ***po-to-ku-ro*** stands for what would appear in Hebrew script as בת כל 'daughter of all' = 'grandtotal'. 'Son' and 'daughter' are often used as the first element of compound nouns in Semitic." [11] Though ingenious, Gordon's interpretation of Linear A ***po-to-ku-ro*** as 'daughter of all' = 'grandtotal' does not appear convincing. So if Hurrian ***kuru***, phonologically /***kuro***/, with Hurrian ***o***-sound, is an exact phonological equivalent to Linear A ***ku-ro***, it is necessary to examine whether ***po-to-*** may also be interpreted as Hurrian, in particular since it has been established that Hurrian cuneiform ***ú*** represents [***u***] and Hurrian cuneiform ***u*** represents [***o***]. In the Tušratta letter (so in fact in the chancellery of the Royal Palace of *Waššukkanni*, where the letter was written) the orthographic conventions were allegedly strictly applied, but elsewhere the scribes seem to have paid less attention to the rules. Anyway Hurrian [***o***] was probably a close sound.

E. Laroche did not attempt to interpret the form *pu-ud-du-ú-uk-ki-a-šu-u-un-na-a-al-la-an*, Mit. III 60.[12] It is important to realize that double writing of consonants in medial position in cuneiform indicates that a consonant is voiceless (***-t-t-*** or ***-d-d-*** is [***t***]), whereas single writing in medial position shows that a consonant is voiced (so ***-t-*** or ***-d-*** is [***d***]). During the last thirty years much progress has been made. Chr. Girbal interprets Hurrian ***puttukki*** [Mit.] as ***puttu-*** 'Leistung', mit ***-kki***.[13] I. Wegner[14] mentions 'achievement'.

Cf. M. Giorgieri, Schizzo grammaticale della lingua hurrica, *Parola del Passato 55 (2000)*, 171-277 (especially 245): /*kuro/u*/ 'di nuovo, d'altra parte'.
Cf. G. Wilhelm, Die Absolutiv-Essiv-Konstruktion des Hurritischen, in: Y. Nishina (ed.), *Europa et Asia polyglotta – Sprachen und Kulturen* (Festschrift für Robert Schmitt-Brandt zum 70. Geburtstag), Dettelbach 2000, 199-208 (especially 201[6]).
Cf. D.R.M. Campbell, *Mood and modality in Hurrian*, Dissertation University of Chicago 2007, 35[48], 299, 314: *kur-o* 'again, subsequently'.
Th. Richter, *Bibliographisches Glossar des Hurritischen*, Wiesbaden 2012, 227, s.v. *kur-* III and *kuru* [Mit.].

[11] C.H. Gordon, *Evidence for the Minoan language*, Ventnor, N.J. 1966, 27, sub 118.

[12] E. Laroche, *Glossaire de la langue hourrite, RHA 34-35 (1976-1977)*, Paris 1978-1979 (reprint 1980), 208, s.v. *pu-ud-du-ú-uk-ki-a-šu-u-un-na-a-al-la-an*, Mit. III 60.

[13] Chr. Girbal, Der Paragraph 24 des Mitanni-Briefes, *ZA 78 (1988)*, 130.

[14] I. Wegner, Suffixaufnahme in Hurrian: Normal cases and special cases, in: F. Plank (ed.), *Double case. Agreement by Suffixaufnahme*, New York – Oxford 1995, 140.

M. Salvini[15] also mentions 'achievement'. M. Giorgieri[16] mentions 'Wert(?)' (***puttū-kki***) and I. Wegner[17] 'Leistung' in her *Einführung in die hurritische Sprache*, Wiesbaden 2007[2]. Th. Richter, who refers to these publications, also mentions a possible relation with the root ***putt-*** II, that might be interpreted as 'ausheben, anwerben.[18]

With regard to a feasible meaning of ***po-to-̲*** in Linear A ***po-to-̲ku-ro*** M. Giorgieri's interpretation of 'value' for Hurrian ***puttu-*** 'Wert(?)' in *puttū-kki* would yield the meaning 'value again' for ***po-to-̲ku-ro***, which is in fact a concept that is expected in the context of the scribe's action of counting several items and giving the total results 'again' (first ***ku-ro***) and 'again' (second ***ku-ro***) and adding the two total numbers together providing 'the *value again*' (***po-to-̲ku-ro***) in the summation of the two totals. The notion 'value' is emphasized by the high numbers of men and commodities mentioned on both HT 122 and HT 131. This means that the sequence ***po-to-̲ku-ro*** or the sequences ***po-to ku-ro*** (HT 122b.6 and HT 131b.4) on these accounting tablets from Hagia Triada does or do not mean 'grand total' as most modern scholars had expected, but simply refer(s) to *the scribe's action of counting the results*. Incidentally, even if the scribe wrote *po-to-̲ku-ro* as one sequence, ***po-to-̲*** should in my view not be taken as a prefix, because Hurrian is only suffixing, but as a term that was so firmly connected with the usage of ***ku-ro*** that the scribe joined the two terms in one notion. If Linear A ***po-to-̲ku-ro*** can be identified with Hurrian ***puttu(-)kuru***, one thing is clear: Linear A ***kuro*** and Hurrian ***kuru*, /*ku-ro*/**, is not a loan-word from another language, but a truly Hurrian adverb, when used without suffixes. Comparison with the related Hurrian verbal root ***kur-*** 'to return' and the parallels with Urartian leave no doubt about that.

A parallel example of bookkeeper's terminology is provided by the term 'sum', if used in the sense of 'total amount resulting from addition of items'. Through Middle English and Old French *summe, somme* it is derived from Latin *summa*, feminine of *summus*, 'highest, at the top'. The etymology of 'sum' can thus be explained from the bookkeeper's action of *placing the total amount* resulting from the addition of items *at the top of the page* instead of at the bottom. So the meaning of 'total amount' of the word 'sum' is secondary. The original meaning is 'at the top' and refers to the bookkeeper's action of putting the total number at the top where it can be seen at a glance. If Minoan scribes were not so much interested in using an abstract notion such as our word 'total', but rather focused on the action and result of counting, interpretation of Linear A *po-to-̲ku-ro* = Hurrian *puttu(-)kuru*, phonologically /*po-to ku-ro*/, 'value again' makes sense in the simple conditions of scribal workshops. If this interpretation is accepted, it is a warning, how cautious one should be not to jump to conclusions too readily because of a seemingly obvious assumption. A. Kober's clever observation was only an indication with regard to the semantic sphere of the term *ku-ro* and should not have been taken too literally.

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[15] M. Salvini, The earliest evidence of the Hurrians before the formation of the Reign of Mittanni, in: G. Buccellati – M. Kelly-Buccellati (ed.), *Urkesh and the Hurrians (Studies in honor of Lloyd Cotsen)*, Bibliotheca Mesopotamica 26, Malibu 1998,103.

[16] M. Giorgieri, Die Beschwörung der 8. Tafel des Šalašu-Rituals, *SCCNH 9 (1998)*, 76[13].

[17] I. Wegner, *Einführung in die hurritische Sprache*, Wiesbaden 2007[2], 274.

[18] Th. Richter, *Bibliographisches Glossar des Hurritischen*, Wiesbaden 2012, 334.

HT 122a. l.]*ra-ri* , *u-de-za* 2
2.] 2 *da-si-85* or: *da-si* TAL 2 *pa-*
3. [.]-[.] [ ]-*di* 1 *te-ki* 2
4. *qa-63-i* 3 *ja-mi-da-re* 1
5. *si-da-re* 1 *so-di-ra* 1 *pa-de* 1
6. *ku-pa₃-nu* 1 *pa-ta-ne* 1 *83a-tu* 1
7. [.]-*du* 1 *ku-pa₃-nu* 1 *da-we-da* 1
8. *ku-ro* 31 *ku-da* 1

HT 122b.1. *je-di* , CAPSUS , VIR[
2. *83a-ki-ta₂* 7 ' [
3. *a-ra-68* < , > *u-de-za* 2 *qa-qa-*
4. *ru* 2 *di* 2 *da-re* 2
4bis. vacat
5. *ku-ro* 65
6. *po-to-ku-ro* 96 [ ]
7. vacat

Sup. mut.
HT 131a. l. FIC 62 *ku*[-*ro*
2. 353 *i-qa*
3. TAL GRA 58
4.] OLE 12 J *67* 12 JE

Sup. mut.
HT 131b.1.] ' ' [
2.] FIC 40 [ ]
3. [ ] OLIVA 2 VIN+*sa* [ ]
4. *po-to-ku-ro* 400[
5. 52 J [

HT 6a.1. *ka-pa* , *da-ta-ra*
2. , *te* , FIC, 15 *pi-ta-ja*
3. 24 *ja+ru* (or: *ru+ja*) DD *ma-3*
4. 10 *o-ra₂-di-ne* 2 *ka-*
5. *pa-qe* 5JE vacat
6. *da-qe-ra* , *qe-pi-ta*
7. 22JE FIC 15J |

HT 6b.1. *wa-du-ni-mi*
2. 3H *ra-ti-se* 1 *ma-*
3. *we-i-no* 3 ,
4. *du-da-ma* 68
5. *me-ki* 3E *sa-ma* 30
6. 5 *pa₃-ni-na* 17J |

Ad a.2: Punctuation after FIC likely accidental. Ad b.5: Raison-Pope: *me-ki*; *GORILA 1*: *da-ki*.

Linear A tablet Hagia Triada HT 6 (HM 8, 1902-1903) was found in the Villa of Hagia Triada as all tablets from HT 1 to HT 84 were found in that part of the Palace-complex. The other tablets from HT 85 onwards were found in the adjacent part called 'Casa del Lebete' by the Italian excavators. They probably date all from the destruction level at the end of Late Minoan I b.

I shall first discuss texts from Hagia Triada with the sequence ***ka-pa*** (HT 6a.1; HT 8b.4; HT 45a.1; HT 94a.1; HT 102.1; HT 105.1; HT 140.5). HT 6 begins with ***ka-pa*** followed by a word divider separating it from the following sequence ***da-ta-ra***. ***ka-pa*** could well be a toponym appearing in the heading of the text as so often happens with toponyms such as ***ko-no-so*** 'Knossos' and ***pu-ro*** 'Pylos' in the headings of the Linear B tablets from Knossos and Pylos, respectively. This observation may be confirmed by the fact that ***ka-pa*** is one of the Linear A sequences which occur relatively frequently, and what may well be significant, so far only in the Linear A texts from Hagia Triada.

In most cases it also appears as the first entry of the texts as here in HT 6a.1, and in HT 94a.1, HT 102.1, HT 105.1, and possibly in the heavily damaged HT 45a.1, where J. Raison - M. Pope, *Index transnuméré du linéaire A* (BCILL 11), read]*29-2*-[. It also occurs in HT 8b.4 and in HT 140.5. The entry of ***ka-pa*** in HT 94a.1 shows that it cannot refer to one person which excludes the possibility of ***ka-pa*** being a personal name, since it is here followed by the ideogram for VIR ('man') followed by the number 62, which probably means that 62 men are recorded with respect to ***ka-pa***.

Another indication that ***ka-pa*** may well represent a toponym in Linear A is that exactly the same sequence occurs in the Knossos Linear B texts reflecting a toponym as well: ***ka-pa*** (KN E 71). Incidentally, the identification of ***ka-pa*** as a toponym in Linear B does not depend on this tablet where the only entry is: ***ka-pa*** GRA[. The occurrence of the ethnic ***ka-pa-jo*** on another Knossos tablet (KN [X] 5752 + B 7039) proves conclusively the existence of the toponym from which the ethnic is derived. Therefore Linear B ***ka-pa*** has been included in a study on Cretan toponyms by M.V. Cremona, D. Marcozzi, A. Scafa and M. Sinatra, *La toponomastica cretese nei documenti in lineare B di Cnosso* (Incunabula Graeca LXIX), Roma 1978, 18, 28-29. They also point out that many Linear B toponyms are followed by the ideogram GRA: "Esaminando la serie E si osserva che generalmente l'ideogramma GRA è preceduto da indicazioni toponimiche: si potrebbe quindi supporre che anche ***ka-pa*** possa essere un toponimo. Nella tavoletta B 5752 troviamo attestata la forma ***ka-pa-jo***: ***ka-pa-jo*** / ***po*** VIR 3. Poiché alla sigla ***po*** (o alla 'scriptio plena' ***po-ku-ta***) si accompagna generalmente un' indicazione toponimica, ne consegue che ***ka-pa-jo*** può essere considerato un etnico. Mettendo a confronto questi due dati sembra dunque lecito ritenere che ***ka-pa*** sia un toponimo, di cui ***ka-pa-jo*** è il relativo etnico." The Linear B suffix ***-jo*** indicates the Greek ethnic suffix ***-yos***.

The observation by the four Italian scholars regarding a connection of Linear B toponyms with the ideogram GRA may be corroborated, if my join of]***-ka-ne*** (AK 3a.1) with ***a***] (AK 1b.1) on a tiny fragment from Arkhanes is correct (*GORILA 3* mentions that AK 1, AK 2 and AK 3 were inscribed by the same *scribe 1*), the resulting sequence ***a***]-***ka-ne*** (AK 3a.1 + AK 1b.1) GRA [represents exactly the toponym *Arkhanes*, where the Villa of Arkhanes was excavated by Yannis and Evi Sakellerakis and where the Linear A Arkhanes-tablets were found.

It corroborates the evidence that the habit of mentioning the place where the tablets were written (preferably at the beginning of a tablet) was probably inherited by the Linear B scribes from their Linear A colleagues. According to Linear A and B orthographic conventions ***-r-*** preceding an occlusive was not expressed in consonant clusters. Eventual final consonants were not expressed either.

The orthographic conventions of Linear B allow several possibilities to interpretion of ***ka-pa***. C.J. Ruijgh, for instance, suggests ***Σκάφᾱ*** for the toponym and ***Σκαφαῖος*** for the ethnic and mentions that *Σκάφη* is attested as a toponym by Suidas. He also refers to *σκάφη* 'bassin' and *σκαφή* 'action de fouir' (cf. C.J. Ruijgh, *EGM,* 227, § 194 and note 87). If , however, ***ka-pa*** in the Linear A texts from Hagia Triada and the Linear B texts from Knossos represents the same toponym, a non-Greek interpretation of the name may be feasible and even preferable. I propose to read ***Ḫalba*** which we know as the Hurrian and later the Hittite designation of 'Aleppo' in Syria, called ***Ḫalab*** in Semitic. It is theoretically possible that Hagia Triada had some overseas connections with Aleppo, the capital of the kingdom of *Yamḫad* in North Syria, whose rulers dominated the kingdoms of Mâri, Alalaḫ and Ugarit among others for a considerable time, or with another place called ***Ḫalba***, but I prefer to see in ***ka-pa*** the designation of the local Cretan toponym referring to Hagia Triada ('Holy Trinity') itself. If this hypothesis is accepted, we should at last have identified the ancient name of the Minoan palace that has yielded the largest number of Linear A texts to date. The Linear B toponym ***ka-pa*** could then be interpreted as ***Χάλβᾱ*** in Mycenaean Greek (= ***Ḫalba*** in Linear A), with correspondence of the Greek aspirate ***χ-*** [***kʰ***] with the voiceless *initial* velar spirant ***ḫ-*** in the cuneiform syllabary and in alphabetic cuneiform of Ugarit. A voiceless velar spirant in *medial* position would be expressed by double writing ***-ḫḫ-*** in the cuneiform syllabary. Linear B ethnic ***ka-pa-jo*** on another Knossos tablet (KN [X] 5752 + B 7039) may then be ***Χάλβαῖος***. Another suggestion may be pertinent in this respect too. In the list of personal names on HT 6a we see ***ka-pa-qe*** in lines 4-5, if the Linear B phonetic values are applied. The same sequence can possibly be read in HT 140.3.

In 'Relations entre le linéaire B et le linéaire A' in *Études Mycéniennes, Actes du colloque international sur les textes mycéniens*, Gif-sur-Yvette 1956, 265, P. Meriggi remarked: "La langue paraît de type flexionnel. On a l'impression que ***-qe*** s'ajoute à la fin de certains mots (***ku-mi-na/ku-mi-na-qe***; ***ka-pa/ka-pa-qe***; ***sa-ro/sa-ro-qe***; etc.) avec valeur copulative, ce qui inclinerait peut-être, mais non nécessairement, vers l'idée d'une langue indo-européenne." M. Lejeune's reply (*ibidem*, 267) to this remark is pertinent in every respect: "Autre remarque, portant sur la méthode. L'identification d'une copule enclitique ***-qe*** serait, évidemment, d'un haut intérêt. Mais, d'abord, c'est supposer que la langue A a possédé des labiovélaires; il est tout aussi possible que les signes ****qa*** (= ***pa₂***) et ***qe*** de B, issus de l'écriture A, aient subi un ajustement au phonétisme grec à partir de valeurs, en A, dont le grec n'avait pas l'emploi. En second lieu, il faudrait que le contexte rendît évident que ce ***-qe***, en A, est une copule et non un suffixe ou une désinence."

It is clear that the sign ***qe*** in Linear B represented a labio-velar sound. It is also clear that Linear B needed its labio-velar signs to represent the labio-velar sounds of Mycenaean Greek. If, however, ***-qe*** in ***ka-pa-qe*** on HT 6a.4-5 represented an enclitic copulative, it would be inexplicable, why the whole list of sequences following ***da-ta-ra***, probably all indicating persons, fails to contain ***-qe*** as its final syllabic sign except ***ka-pa-qe***.

Interpreting final ***-qe*** in ***ka-pa-qe*** as a suffix in Linear A would then be much more feasible than the use of an enclitic copulative only in one item of the list.

In line with M. Lejeune, who had apparently already in 1956 serious doubts about an alleged labio-velar value of the Linear A signs which had a graphic identity with their Linear B counterparts, I propose to read the Linear A sign "***qe***" as a syllable beginning with a voiced velar spirant or fricative, represented by ***-ḫe(-)*** in syllabic cuneiform in medial and final position and in the cuneiform alphabet of Ugarit by ***ġ*** (***ǧ***), cf. E. Laroche, *GLH,* Paris 1978-1979, 22-24. This sound shares at least the velar characteristics with the labio-velar sounds, which might explain why Linear B scribes may have adopted the Linear A signs with these sounds for the labio-velar series in Linear B. If my view is correct, the Linear A voiced velar spirant, conventionally written ***qe*** (as in Linear B), but in reality reflecting [***ġe***], and the Linear B labio-velar ***qe*** should certainly not be confused with cuneiform emphatic ***qe***. To prevent confusion it may be wise to change the conventional spelling of the Linear A "***q-***" signs officially into ***ḫ-*** signs in the future, see the Linear A grid (Volume I, Part I, page 6).

The voiceless velar spirants are represented in syllabic cuneiform by ***ḫ-*** in initial position, by double writing of ***-ḫḫ-*** in medial position and in alphabetic Ugaritic by ***ḫ*** in all positions.

E. A. Speiser (*Introduction to Hurrian,* New Haven 1941, 48-49, § 58): "In RŠ X 4.10 we find the frase ***tšb ḫlb-x*** which contains a reference to Teshub of Aleppo. [….] The adjectival form, on the other hand is found in the syllabary as ***Ḫalba-ḫi***, cf. J. Friedrich, *Analecta Orientalia 12,* 127, and add the Nuzi name ***Ḫalbaḫi***; cf. SAL *Ḫa-al-pa-ḫi* SMN 345 (= unpublished Nuzi texts, Semitic Museum, Harvard); SAL *Ḫal-pa-a-ḫi* SMN 352. If we take alphabetic ***x*** in the all but generally accepted value of ***ġ*** (voiced velar spirant), the equation ***ḫ1b·ġ = Ḫalba-ḫi*** will satisfy perfectly the phonetic requirements as well as the context." Now the value ***ġ*** in the alphabetic syllabary of Ugarit is generally accepted, but E.A. Speiser (*IH*, 49, § 59) had provided the pertinent evidence: "The independent testimony of RŠ material supports, therefore, the evidence of the syllabary based on the differences between ***-ḫ-*** and ***-ḫḫ-***. These two forms may now be equated with their respective alphabetic equivalents. Single ***ḫ*** in intervocalic position corresponds to alphabetic ***ġ***, as is shown by ***Ḫalbaḫi = ḫ1bġ*** and ***Lubtuḫi = lbtġ***. Accordingly, intervocalic ***-ḫḫ-*** should appear in RŠ as ***ḫ***. This equation may now be illustrated by a convincing pair of instances. Alongside syllabic ***turuḫḫi(na)*** 'male' and ***aštuḫḫi(na)*** 'female' we get alphabetic ***trḫn*** and ***astḫn*** (RŠ X 4. 55ff). We see, incidentally, that the double writing of the main syllabary has the same purpose in the case of the velars that has previously been noted with the stops, ***s***, ***z*** and ***f***, ***v***: it signifies lack of voice, while single writing marks the respective voiced sound."

If the voiceless velar spirants in Linear A could be represented by the ***k***-series, Linear A ***ka-pa-qe*** can be equated with the ethnic ***Ḫalbaḫe*** in the main cuneiform syllabary and ***ḫlbġ*** in the cuneiform alphabet from Ugarit, meaning 'Man from Ḫalba' with the Hurrian ethnic suffix ***-ḫi/-ḫe***, [***ġe***]. E. Laroche (*GLH*, 22): "Il est légitime, par example, d'interpréter comme ethnique un nom en ***-ḫi/ḫe***, …" *Ibidem* (p. 90) s.v. ***Ḫalba***: Alep: 1. La métropole syrienne. Nom. ***^{uru}Ḫal-pa,*** KBo XIX 135 III 8. Dat. *^{uru}Ḫal-pa-(a)-pa,* KUB XLV 84 Ro 13; XLVII 101 IV 5; 2. Ethnique *Ḫalbaḫi* 'Alépin', Sg. *^{uru}Ḫal-pa-a-ḫi,* KBo VII 61,3.- P1. *^{uru}Ḫal-pa-ḫi-n*[*a*]*,* KBo VIII 147,2. - Nom d'homme *Ḫalpaḫi, NH* No. 253. Nom.*^{m} Ḫal-pa-ḫi-iš* KBo III 3 IV 4,7 = KUB XIX 44 IV 4,7; 3. Tešub de Ḫalpa, près d'Ugarit. Cf. E. Laroche, *Les Noms des Hittites,* Paris 1966, 273: ***Ḫalbaḫi*** 'Alépin', ethnique hourrite en ***-ḫi***.

[……]

As mentioned before, according to Th. Richter (*VHN*, *passim*) verbal forms in ***-u*** in personal names can also be interpreted as Old Hurrian *imperatives*, so that ***da-du-te*** (HT 34.1) can also be translated as 'Love (the child), oh Tešub !' (***-te*** is a common hypocoristic of ***-teš(š)ub***). Only if ***da-du-te*** is analysed as {*dad=o/u=m-te*}, which is conceivable, since ***-m-*** before occlusive is not expressed in Linear A consonant clusters, translating 'Tešub loved (the child) and still loves it' is required.

Another personal name ***Tatip-tešup*** (wr. *Ta-ti-ip-te-šup*) at Nuzi (cf. I.J. Gelb, *NPN*, 150; P.M. Purves, *NPN*, 263, s.v. *tat*, *tatip-*) can now also be recognized as an 'Old Hurrian' formation. Formerly E.A. Speiser (*IH*, 140, § 177) explained the suffix ***-p-*** (phonologically probably ***/b/***) as a 'root-complement' with an 'asseverative' value: "Finally, the suffix ***-b***, which is more common by far in names than all the others combined, appears to have had an asseverative connotation [175 (4)]."

Since publication of the Hurrian-Hittite bilingual *Kirenze* (KBo 32), we know that ***Tatip-tešup*** can be analysed as Old Hurrian {*tad=i=b-tešub*}, consisting of the verbal root ***tad-*** + the marker of transitivity ***-i-*** + the marker of the subject ***-b*** (cf. I. Wegner, *Einführung*, 126), 'He, Tešub, loves (the child)'. This means that Old Hurrian ***tad=i=b*** equals Mitanni-Hurrian ***tad=i=a*** 'he/she loves'. According to Th. Richter (*VHN*, 574-575, sub 1.1.1.2.1: verbal forms in ***°=i=b***) ***=i=*** is qualified as 'Valenzanzeiger' ['value-indicator', i.e. 'suffix indicating transitivity'] and ***=b-*** is the subject-marker of the 3rd person singular of the indicative. He also mentions that the high number of transitive non-ergative indicative names (in the corpus of names in *VHN* I) is due to the fact that some of the most frequent roots are mainly or even entirely built in this way: ***ar-*** 'to give (a child)' (21x); ***eḫl-*** 'to rescue, save (a child)' (12x); ***ḫaš-*** 'to hear (a person), answer (a prayer)' (26x); ***kir-*** 'to liberate, manumit, set free (a slave child) ?' (10x).

The Hurrian personal names ***Tatunna*** (wr. *Ta-du-un-na*) and ***Tatuni*** (wr. *Da-du-ni*) from Nuzi (I.J. Gelb, *NPN*, 150) can be analysed as {*tad=o/u=nna*} and {*dad=o/u=nni*}, respectively, consisting of the verbal root ***d/tad-*** + the Old Hurrian suffix marking the past tense or the Old Hurrian imperative suffix ***-o/u-*** + the enclitic personal pronoun 3rd person singular ***-nna***, c.q. optional allomorphic ***-nni***, indicating the object of the transitive verb.

Another sequence with ***dad=u-*** as first element is Linear A ***da-du-mi-ne*** (KN Zf 31) on a silver hairpin for a woman (HM 540, 1927/1971) from the Minoan Necropolis of Mavro Spilio, east of the Palace of Minos, Chambre Tomb IX, B 2, style Late Minoan 1a (M.S.F. Hood, *Archaeological survey of the Knossos area*, British School at Athens: F 6, point 95). The Linear A inscription continues in one line on one side of the pin. The other side of the pin carries a row of crocus blossoms, cf. E.J. Forskyke, The Mavro Spelio cemetery at Knossos, *BSA XXVIII (1926-1927)*, 267 ff, pl. IXB.2, 289, fig. 38; St. Alexiou – W.C. Brice, A silver pin from Mavro Spelio with an inscription in Linear A: Her. Mus. 540, *Kadmos 11.2 (1072)*, 113-124, pl. I-II, fig. 1-9; cf. L. Godart – J.-P. Olivier, Sur l'épingle de Mavro Spelió, *BCH 100 (1976)*, 309-314; *GORILA 4 (1982)*, XXXIV-XXXV, 154-155: KN Zf 31: Épingle en argent. The silver hairpin was found in the same Chambre Tomb IX as the MM III gold signet ring with spiral Linear A inscription from Mavro Spilio (KN Zf 13). The silver pin came from compartment B 2, whereas the gold ring came from compartment E 1.

Linear A ***da-du-mi-ne*** (KN Zf 31) may well be analysed as {*dad=u/o-min(a)=ni/e*} consisting of the verbal root ***dad-*** + Old Hurrian imperative suffix ***-o/u-*** and nominal element {*min(a)=ni/e*}, object of the verb. Translation: 'love the twin (oh *numen*) !', if it is an *imperative* form in context [like ***a-wa-pi*** (KN Zf 31) {*aw-abi*} 'save (the deceased person), oh necromantic sacrificial pit' on the same silver hairpin] or 'Love the twin (oh *numen*) !', if it is a personal name, The lexeme ***mena / mina*** is an ***a***-stem, since it belongs to the category of Hurrian words designating congeniality or kinship such as: ***šala*** 'daughter', ***šena*** 'brother', ***ela*** 'sister', ***nera*** 'mother', ***mena*** 'twin(?)' or 'sister(?)' (as proposed by Th. Richter), cf. I. Wegner (*Einführung*, 52). I prefer the meaning 'twin' to 'sister', not only because there is already a word for 'sister' in Hurrian, namely ***ela***, but in particular since there are places, where names for men contain ***mena-***, ***mina-***, or ***ᵒmen(a)=ne/i***, ***ᵒmin(a)=ne/i***. The lexeme with the ***a***-stem is written with single ***-n-*** in cuneiform, whereas the form ending in ***-e/i*** is often written with double ***-nn-***, because the so-called definite article ***-ne/-ni*** is added and the ***-a*** of the ***a***-stem is lost by syncope.

At Mari the personal name ***ᶠTatum-menni*** (wr. *ᶠTa-du-um-me-ni*) is attested, analysis {*tad=o=m-men(a)=ni*}, typology 1.1.1.1.1, lexicon *tad-*, *mena*, 'Das Geschwister liebte (Mädchen)' ['The sister loved (the girl)'], cf. Th. Richter, *VHN*, 303, 533-534, s.v. ***tad-/tatt-***. As argued, I should prefer the translation 'The twin loved (the girl)'. We see here that the writing with double ***-mm-*** in ***ᶠTatum-menni*** shows that we are dealing with an *indicative* construction of which ***-menni*** can be the subject (as can be observed in Th. Richter's translation), but ***-menni*** can also be the object, if we translate 'He/She (***-m***) (a *numen*) loved the twin-sister'. If Linear A ***da-du-mi-ne*** (KN Zf 31) is analysed likewise as an *indicative* construction {*dad=u/o=m-min(a)=ni/e*}, I translate 'He/She (***=m-***) (a *numen*) loved the twin'. The Minoan scribe no doubt knew, whether the name constituted an *imperative* (with single *m* belonging to *min(a)=ni/e*) or an *indicative* construction (with double *m-m*), but Linear A orthography, that only has single writing of consonants, does not show this distinction. In cuneiform the feminine determinative shows that ***ᶠTatum-menni*** was a girl, but Linear A ***da-du-mi-ne*** (KN Zf 31) misses such determinatives.

Since Mavro Spilio may well be a necropolis belonging to the Palace of Minos at Knossos, it seems attractive to identify the Hurrian word ***mina / mena*** 'twin' with the name of the mythical King of Knossos, *Μίνως* (Minōs). If that identification is correct, we may conclude that King *Minos* of Knossos and King *Rhadamanthys* of Phaistos were not only brothers, but probably also twins. It is indeed encouraging that the onomastic element ***mina*** is attested in Linear A: ***a-ku-mi-na*** (ZA 10.1-2), ***a-du-|ku-mi-na*** (ZA 10a.3-4) from Kato Zakro, ***mi-nu-te*** (HT 86a.5; HT 106.1), ***mi-<u>nu</u>-te*** (HT 95a.2; HT 95b.2-3) from Hagia Triada and last but not least ***da-du-mi-ne*** (KN Zf 31) from Mavro Spilio (Knossos).

It must be noted that the orthography of ***da-du-mi-ne*** allows another analysis, namely {*dad=u/o=m-i/eni/e*} 'He/She (***=m-***), *a* God (***ine***), loved (the child)' or {*dad=u/o=m-i/en(i)=ne*} 'He/She (***=m-***), *the* God (***inne***), loved (the child)'. Especially in personal names singular ***ini/e*** 'god' and ***in(i)=ni/e*** 'the god' occur often, whereas in context ***eni/e*** and ***en(i)=ni/e*** are relatively more common. The Minoan scribe no doubt knew, which of these analyses represented the name of the person in question, if ***da-du-mi-ne*** is a personal name and not an expression in context on the silver hairpin (HM 540) at Mavro Spilio.

Since ŠEŠ is the Sumerogram for 'brother', the personal name ***Tati-***ŠEŠ (wr. ^{m}*Ta-ti-*ŠEŠ, XXXI 62 II 10, cf. E. Laroche, *NH*, 182, n° 1309) is equivalent to ***Tati-šen***, ***Tati-šena*** or ***Tati-šen(a)=ne/i*** and can be translated as 'Love the brother (oh *numen*) !'. In the Hurrian names *Še-en-da-da* from Nippur (cf. Clay, *PNCP* 131) and *Še-en-na-ta-ti* and *Še-en-da-ti* from Nuzi (cf. P.M. Purves, *NPN*, 263, s.v. *tat*), the verbal and nominal elements seem to have switched positions as compared to ***Tati-***ŠEŠ. This is possible as ^{f}***Alla-tatum*** (wr. ^{f}*Al-la-ta-dum*) from Mari, {*alla-tad=o=m*}, 'The Lady loved the girl', shows.

But there is also another explanation feasible. Th. Richter (*VHN*, 533-534, s.v. ***tad-/tatt-***) mentions that the lexeme ***tadi*** can mean 'Liebe' ['love'] and in onomastics also 'Liebling' ['darling']. This means that *Še-en-da-da* from Nippur can also be translated as 'The brother is *as* a darling' (***-dada*** *essive* in ***-a***) and *Še-en-na-ta-ti* and *Še-en-da-ti* from Nuzi as 'The brother is a darling'. Th. Richter (*VHN*, 534) mentions the examples ^{f}***Akap-tati*** 'Der Liebling (≈ Neugeborenes Mädchen) kam herauf' ['The darling (≈ the newborn girl) came up'] and ^{f}***Taka-tati*** from Mari, 'Sei (oder: werde) schön, oh Liebling !' ['Be (or: Become) beautiful, oh darling !']. ***Urḫa-tati*** (wr. *Ur-ḫa-ta-ti*) at Nuzi (cf. Purves, *NPN*, 263), phonologically /*Urḫa-dadi*/, 'Be true, oh darling !' may corroborate this view.

After the conclusion (*vide supra*) that Linear A ***da-we-da*** (HT 10a.5; HT 85a.2; HT 93a.7; HT 122a.7), occurring four times, cannot be identified as the Semitic name 'David' (as C.H. Gordon proposed, followed by J.G.P. Best), we need to examine in which way the sequence might be interpreted. Since its final syllabic sign is ***-da***, it may contain the Hurrian *directive* suffix ***-da*** that can be used with nouns, personal names, toponyms and theonyms (see e.g. the lists of Hurrian theonyms combined with this suffix ***-da*** in the cuneiform syllabary and with ***-d*** in alphabetic cuneiform of Ugarit, indicating 'to, towards, for' (cf. E. Laroche, *GLH*, 26; cf. I. Wegner, *Einführung*, 65: Table 1: Paradigm of the Hurrian case-endings).

There is one problem due to the Linear A orthographic rule that final consonants were never expressed: Hurrian had also an *ablative* suffix ***-dan*** indicating 'from' (cf. Laroche, *ibidem*; Wegner, *ibidem*), of which the final ***-n*** is not expressed in Linear A. This did probably not pose any serious problem to the scribes, since they obviously knew what they had in mind, but it does to us, because there is no way for us to distinguish the *directive* form from the *ablative* in Linear A orthography. So if ***da-we-da*** refers to a delivery, we have to live with the fact that we shall never know whether it went to ***da-wa*** or had arrived from it.

The *absolutive* form could be represented as ****da-we-*** on account of ***da-we-da*** (HT 10a.5; HT 85a.2; HT 93a.7; HT 122a.7), but Linear A ***da-wa*** (KN Za 10b) seems preferable on account of its occurrence without the suffix ***-da*** or ***-dan*** on a fragment of a Libation Table of banded limestone (HM 2100, 1923) from the Palace of Knossos: House of the frescoes (north-west of the palace): Survey E 7, point 123.Type: P. Warren, *MSV*: 26. 2B, probably Late Minoan I. The inscription on the Libation Table reads:

KN Za 10a.]-*ta-nu-a-ti* , *ja-sa-sa-ra-ma-*

b. *na* , *da-wa* ̣ [.]-*du-wa-to* , *i-ja*[

The form ***da-we-da*** < ****da-wa-da*** might, for instance, be the result of initial accent. In the Linear B texts from Knossos the toponym ***da-wo*** (KN Ak 621 *et al.*), probably equivalent to Linear A ***da-wa***, is found with its Mycenaean Greek ending in ***-oς*** or ***-ov***.

The Linear B name ***da-wo*** (KN Ak 621 *et al.*) is firmly established as a toponym on the basis of the ethnics ***da-wi-jo*** (KN Am 568, KN Og 427 +8102.1, *et.al.*) and ***da-wi-ja*** (KN Ak 780; KN L 641.2), derived from ***da-wo***, which is included as a toponym in *La toponomastica cretese nei documenti in lineare B di Cnosso* by M.V. Cremona, D. Marcozzi, E. Scafa, M. Sinatra, Incunabula Graeca LXIX, *passim*.

Since I am quite sure that the phonetic value of Linear A sign ***96*** and its variant ***68*** (comparable with Linear B sign ****65***) can be identified as ***ḫi*** (see the great number of confirmative matches in *chapter 12: From undeciphered to deciphered Linear A signs*), it is now also possible to recognize the Linear A ethnic ***da+wa+ḫi*** (TY 2 + fr.) on a Linear A tablet (HM 1374, 1909) from magazine η = room 5 of house A at Tylissos, that is unique and enigmatic, because the main ideograms look like circles bigger than those indicating the number 'hundred' on the same tablet with 'tens' following.

On this tablet a ligature ***da+wa+96 = da+wa+ḫi*** (TY 2.5 + fr.) can be read from top to bottom (↓) to the right of a circular ideogram **309b* in the classification of *GORILA 5*, 291: **309a* indicates a circle without attachments; **309b* shows a circle with an attachment underneath and **309c* a circle within a circle. Could they be the bronze cauldrons, also found in room 5 (cf. J. Hazzidakis, *Les villas minoennes de Tylissos*, Études crétoises III, Paris 1934, 15). Are the numbers too high for one location ? Or could they indicate round shields belonging to an arsenal and could the attachments be leather straps attached to them ? There are more examples of armour in Linear A.

Anyway the Hurrian ethnic ***da+wa+ḫi*** (TY 2.5) is in fact equivalent to the Mycenaean Greek ethnics ***da-wi-jo*** and ***da-wi-ja*** like Linear A ***ka-\|pa-qe*** (HT 6a.4-5) = Hurrian ***Ḫalba=ḫe*** 'man of *Ḫalba* (Aleppo)' is equivalent to Mycenaean Greek ***ka-pa-jo*** (KN [X] 5752 + B 7039, Olivier), ethnic of Linear B ***ka-pa*** GRA[(KN E 71).

There may still be one indication significant for the interpretation of ***da-we-da*** (HT 10a.5; HT 85a.2; HT 93a.7; HT 122a.7). In most cases it seems to occur in lists of personal names, which means that ***da-we-da*** does not refer to a delivery to or from ***da-wa***, but to a person, probably from ***da-wa***. This means that ***da-we-da*** could mean 'man/woman (coming) from *Dawa*'. In that case the sequence shows the provenance of the person with the ablative suffix ***-dan***, almost in the same way as an ethnic does. For instance, ***da-we-da*** 1 (HT 122a.7) is preceded by ***ku-pa$_3$-nu*** 1 (HT 122a.7), whereas in the preceding line ***pa-ta-ne*** (HT 122a.6) is preceded by ***ku-pa$_3$-nu*** 1 (HT 122a.6). Linear A ***pa-ta-ne***, that also occurs in HT 94b.1, can be interpreted as 'the one of Sparta' or 'Spartan' (with the 'so-called' definite article, also called individualizing suffix ***-ne/-ni***), since ***s*** preceding ***p***, and ***-r-*** preceding ***-t-*** (in fact non-occlusives preceding occlusives) were according to the orthographic conventions of Linear A and B not expressed in consonant clusters. One may compare Linear B ***pe-mo = σπέρμο*** (PY Ep 301,1 *et alibi*) and ***pe-ma = σπέρμα*** (PY Er 312,2 *e.a.*) 'seed, in particular of grain'. Another Linear A inscription offers a similar parallel, again a combination with ***ku-pa$_3$-nu***. HT(?) 170b.3-4 reads:]' 1 ***ku-pa$_3$-nu*** SUS+***si+re*** 1 ***pa-ta-da*** |] 1. So it seems justifiable to interpret ***pa-ta-da*** as '(the one coming) from *Sparta*'. On a pithos fragment from Hagia Triada ***pa-ta-da du-pu$_2$-re***[(HT Zb 160) is the only preserved entry. Although no word divider is visible between ***-da*** and ***du-***, the distance between the signs is slightly larger than between the others.

Moreover, both ***pa-ta-da*** and ***du-pu₂-re*** occur as separate sequences elsewhere. It is therefore justifiable to treat them here as separate entries as well. Linear A ***du-pu₂-re*** also occurs in some libation formulas.

Since ***pa-ta-da*** |] 1 (HT(?) 170b.3-4) occurs in a list of personal names which makes translation as '(The one) from Sparta' possible (with ablative suffix ***-dan***), the sequence]***ku-du-we*** CAP^{m} 1 (HT(?) 170a.2) on the other side of the tablet offers another parallel, since it can be interpreted as the Hurrian *genitive* in ***-we/-wi*** of Linear A ***ku-da*** 1 (HT 122a.8), that may well be a toponym, since the ethnic ***ku-do-ni*** (HT 13.4; HT 85a.4) and possibly ***ku-do-ni***[(HT 101.4) 'the one of Kuda', 'man/woman of Kuda', derived from *Kuda*, is attested as well. If the reading of]***ku-du-we*** is correct, the change of ***-a- > -u-*** from ****ku-da-we > ku-du-we*** can be explained, for ***u*** is cognate with ***w***. Since]***ku-du-we*** refers to a person, the meaning is 'The one of *Kuda*'. Such formations with genitive forms are also attested in Hurrian names written with cuneiform, e.g. ^{f}***Azzue*** (wr. ^{f}*Az-zu-e,* ^{f}*A-zu-e*), name of 11 ladies from Mari and of one from Qaṭṭarā, {*azz(e)/azz(o/u)=ve*}, 'The one (girl) of the woman' (cf. Th. Richter, *VHN*, 81-82), cf. ^{f}***Azue*** (wr. ^{f}*A-zu-(ú-)e*) from Nuzi (cf. I.J. Gelb, *NPN*, 41; *AAN* I 39, *SANTAG* 4, 257), ^{f}***Azue*** (wr. ^{f}*A-zu-e*) from Cappadocia, ICK I 16 A 4, 7, B 3 (cf. E. Laroche, *NH*, 50, n° 219), etc.

Attestation of the ethnic ***pa-ta-qe*** (HT 31.6) 'Spartan' (?), written on top of the ideogram of a vessel VAS^{a1}, with ***-qe*** as the Hurrian adjectival and ethnic suffix ***-ḫe/-ḫi***, makes it very likely that ****pa-ta*** is indeed a toponym. Ideogram VAS^{a1} + ***pa-ta-qe*** is followed by the high number of 3000. Parallel for usage of the ethnic suffix ***-ḫe/-ḫi*** is Linear A ***ka-pa-qe*** (HT 6a.4-5) = Hurrian ***Ḫalbaḫe***, alphabetic cuneiform ***Ḫlbġ***, 'man of *Ḫalba*', derived from the Linear A and B toponym ***ka-pa*** = '*Ḫalba*' (Hurrian name of Aleppo in Syria, called *Ḫalab* in Semitic, but in the Cretan context designating the Hurrian toponym of the Palace of Hagia Triada itself). Compare also the Linear B ethnic ***ka-pa-jo *Χαλβαῖος*** 'man of *Ḫalba*', provided with the Greek ethnic suffix ***-yos***.

The parallel form ***pa-ta-ne*** (HT 94b.1; HT 122a.6) 'the Spartan one' (with the suffix ***-ne/-ni*** can also be regarded as an ethnic. Both ethnics ***pa-ta-qe*** and ***pa-ta-ne*** are derived from the *substrate* toponym ****pa-ta***, probably 'Sparta'. P. Chantraine (*DELG*, 1033) mentions s.v. *Σπάρτη* that the etymology is obscure. One has attempted to compare *σπείρω*, *σπάρτη* and (more plausibly) the name of a plant *σπάρτος*. He concludes (with A. Heubeck) that a substrate term is most likely.

Compare the parallel usage of the suffixes ***-ne/-ni*** and ***-ḫe*** in the Hurrian ethnics ***Masrianne*** 'Egyptian' **:** ***Ḫurroḫe*** 'Hurrian'. Compare for the usage of the Hurrian ethnic suffix ***-ḫe/-ḫi*** in combination with a non-Hurrian name e.g. the ethnic ***Aggadaḫi*** (wr. ^{uru}*A-ag-ga-da-a-ḫi*) 'Akkadian' KUB XLV 41 III 3, with the *directive* suffix ***-da***, KUR *Ag-ga-tu-ḫé-da* 'to the land of Akkad' KUB VII 31 Ro 7, cf. E. Laroche, *GLH*, 40.

If one accepts the possibility of identification of Linear A ****pa-ta-*** with 'Sparta', one could think of trade of Hagia Triada with Lakonia, Sparta in particular, which was a Mycenaean centre after all. The designation ***pa-ta-qe*** (HT 31.6) 'Spartan' could specify either the 3000 vessels indicated by the ideogram and/or the contents of the vessels.

In view of such trade it may be significant that on the island of Kythera across the Lakonian coast a very small Linear A inscription (KY Zg 1) dating from Middle-Minoan IIIb is visible on a clay weight (Khora Museum, 1965), only with sign ***L100a*** = ***i***, according to *Nestor*, 1-10-1965, 407 and J. Raison - M. Pope, *Corpus transnuméré du linéaire A*, Louvain 1980, 247; 1994, 245. However, L. Godart – J.-P. Olivier (*GORILA 4*, 1982, XXXIV-XXXV; 160) read ***606*** = GRA+E. Since the GRANUM ideogram with fraction sign E appears to suite the purpose of a clay weight better than sign ***i***, identification of GRA+E seems preferable. J.G. Younger reads GRA+E {**581*} and remarks that the fraction E [1/4] presumably refers to the weight of the weight.

Another Linear A inscription, ***da-ma-te*** (KY Za 2), occurs on a serpentine ladle (Piraeus Museum 6588) found in the Peak Sanctuary of Hagios Georgios on Kythera.

Moreover, the Linear A inscription ***a-ma*** (HS Zg 1.2) has been found on a schist plaque from Hagios Stephanos (Lakonia). However, it cannot be ruled out that there was a place called 'Sparta' in Crete as well.

Less probable is another theoretical interpretation of Linear A ***pa-ta-qe*** (HT 31.6) as an equivalent to the Hurrian divinity of Šuta in Mitanni, ***^{d}Pardaḫi***, wr. *^{d}Pár-da-a-ḫi*, KBo I 3 Vo 43 = *^{d}Pa-ar-ta-*[*ḫi*], KBo I 1 Vo 57, cf. E. Laroche, *GLH*, 195, s.v. *Pardaḫi*. This interpretation would only be possible, if the dental of *^{d}Pardaḫi* is voiceless, as indicated by ***-ta-*** in Linear A ***pa-ta-qe***, but the dental of *^{d}Pardaḫi* seems voiced. Moreover, if Linear A ***pa-ta-qe*** could be explained as ***^{d}Pardaḫi***, the cross-references with Linear A ***pa-ta-ne*** and ***pa-ta-da*** would no longer make sense. Another problem is that the significance of mentioning a divinity with regard to vessels is not self-evident, unless a temple of this divinity with a cultic function of such vessels was involved. But the high number of 3000 points rather to a merely commercial transaction. So we may conclude that all evidence shows that interpretation of Linear A ***pa-ta-qe*** as {*Sparta=ḫe*} 'Spartan' is to be preferred.

A perforated sealstone (KT Zg 2a-b) of black-green steatite in the form of a bobbin / reel (*CMX* XI, n° 96), donated by R.B. Seager to the Metropolitan Museum in New York (26.31.158), probably from Crete (provenance uncertain) bears a Linear A inscription:

a. | ***te-ro-a*** | [← as read from the sealstone] =
| ***a-ro-te*** | [→ as read from the seal-impression]
b. | ***da-da-i*** | [← as read from the sealstone] =
| ***i-da-da*** | [→ as read from the seal-impression].

I begin with interpretation of Linear A | ***i-da-da*** | (KT Zg 2.b) [→ as read from the seal-impression], because it contains either the Hurrian *directive* suffix ***-da*** or the *ablative* suffix ***-dan*** as ***da-we-da*** and ***pa-ta-da*** just discussed.

The name of Mount ***Ida*** (***Ἴδη***) in central Crete, attested in Linear A as ***i-da*** (PK Za 17; ZA 21b.1; ZA 27a.1) from Mount Petsophas (Palaikastro) and Kato Zakro, can be analysed as Hurrian ***id=a=Ø*** 'He (the mountain god) thunders' or 'It (the mountain) thunders', consisting of the root ***id-*** + the indicator of intransitivity ***-a-*** + enclitic personal pronoun 3rd person singular intransitive indicative ***Ø*** as subject indicator (so not ***-nna***), cf. I Wegner, *Einführung*, 99 (Table 6 and 7: The order of suffixes of the indicative, intransitive-positive and intransitive-negative verb and of the antipassive verb).

In fact the Linear A form | ***i-da-da*** | (KT Zg 2.b) proves that Linear A ***i-da*** (ZA 21b.1; ZA 27a.1), although originally a verbal form ***id=a=Ø***, may already have become the nominal designation of the mountain itself in Minoan times, because the Linear A sequence shows clear features of a noun, since the Hurrian suffixes ***-da*** and ***-dan*** are the *directive* case-ending ***-da*** 'to', and the *ablative* case-ending ***-dan*** 'from', respectively, cf. I. Wegner, *Einführung*, 65 (Table 1: Paradigm of the Hurrian case-endings).

If the form ***i-da-da*** (KT Zg 2.b) is analysed as {*ida=da*}, it may well consist of the name of mount ***Ida*** + the Hurrian directive suffix ***-da*** 'to' and is therefore comparable with Greek ****Ἴδαν-δε***, accusative of ***Ἴδα*** + the directive suffix ***-δε***.

However, since a final consonant is not expressed in Linear A and B, Linear A final ***-da*** in ***i-da-da*** can also represent the Hurrian ablative suffix ***-dan*** 'from', so that {*ida=dan*} can be compared with Greek ***Ἴδηθεν <*Ἴδᾱ-θεν***, cf. *Iliad* Γ 276: *Ἴδηθεν* 'from (mount) Ida'. The scribe no doubt knew which of the two suffixes he meant, but we cannot be sure. So it seems that we have to live with this ambiguity (or deficiency) resulting from Linear A (and B) orthographic conventions.

Homer refers to the *Ida*-mountains in the Troad (*Iliad* B 821, B 824, Θ 47 f., 75, 410, 438f., Λ 105, 182 f., 337, M 18-24, 253, N 13, Ξ 283 ff., O 5, 79, 146 ff., Π 666-667, P 594 ff., Y 57-59, 91, 189, 215-218, Φ 449, X 170 f.), where Zeus had his temenos and altar on the highest top *Gargaron* (*Iliad* Θ 47). The name is also known from Phrygia and Mysia. D. Detschew, *Die thrakischen Sprachreste*, Vienna 1957, 214, also mentions a polis ***Ἴδη*** between Kardia and Alopekonnesos on the Thracian Chersonese, mentioned by Scylax 67: *μετὰ δὲ τὸν Μέλανα κόλπον ἐστὶν ἡ Θρᾳκία Χερρόνησος καὶ πόλεις ἐν αὐτῇ αἵδε· Καρδία, Ἴδη, Παιών, Ἀλωπεκόννησος* (cf. also D.A. Hester, 'Pelasgian - a new Indo-European language ?', *Lingua 13 (1965)*, 372-373). However, Linear A ***i-da*** no doubt refers to *Ida* in central Crete.

P. Chaintraine, *Dictionnaire étymologique de la langue grecque*, 455, s.v. ***ἴδη***: "dor. ***ἴδᾱ*** f. 'bois, forêt' (Hdt., Théocr.). Vieux mot qui fournit le toponyme ***Ἴδη***, massif montagneux en Mysie occidentale (Iliade etc.) et en Crète (D.P., Paus.), d'où ***Ἴδηθεν***, ***Ἰδαῖος*** (Iliade etc.). Comme le confirme le toponyme, doit être un terme indigène préhellénique, donc sans étymologie établie."

According to J. Chadwick - L. Baumbach, The Mycenaean Greek vocabulary, *Glotta 41 (1963)*, 157-271, s.v. ***ἴδη***, Doric ***ἴδᾱ*** < * ***ϝίδᾱ*** 'forest', an initial digamma is attested through a Cretan inscription ***Βίδᾱν*** (*Del.* 177, 2). D. Detschew, *Die thrakischen Sprachreste*, 558, mentions ***ῥαθιβίδα*** 'Schamkraut' (Diosc. 4, 119 RV), Dacian name of a plant, which he analyses as Dacian ***ῥαθι-*** from an I.E. root *rēt-*, *rōt-*, *rət-* 'rod, thin tree-trunk / stem' (Walde-Pokorny 2, 368) and ***-βίδα*** from *widh-* 'wood' (cf. *ἴδη ναυπηγήσιμος* 'wood for shipbuilding' (Herodotos V, 23).

According to C.J. Ruijgh (*EGM*, § 188[+44]) the Linear B name ***wi-da-jo*** (KN V 60,3) may be ***Fīδαῖος***, ethnic of ****Fίδᾱ***, or be derived from ***ϝίδᾱ*** 'wood, forest'. In the latter case the meaning of ***Fīδαῖος*** might be 'forester'. He also refers to the probably Pre-Greek personal names ***wi-da-ka-so*** (KN D 1402) and ***wi-da-ma-ro*** (KN Do 919) in Linear B.

However, Linear A ***i-da*** (PK Za 17; ZA 21b.1; ZA 27a.1), | ***i-da-da*** | (KT Zg 2.b), ***i-da-a*** (KO Za 1.b-c), ***i-da-ja*** (PK Za 18), ***i-da-ma-te*** (AR Zf 1; AR Zf 2), ***i̲-du-ti*** (HT 104.2-3) are names without initial ***w-***.

Linear B ***i-da-i-jo*** (KN K 875,4; PY An 661,2), ***Ἰδαῖος***, ***i-do-me-ne-ja*** (PY Eb 498,1; PY Ep 212,9), ***Ἰδομένεια***, feminine of ***Ἰδομενεύς***, and ***i-do-me-ni-jo*** (PY Gn 428,5; PY Fn 324,7), dative of ***Ἰδομένιος***, are also attestations of names without initial ***ϝ-***. This definitely proves that these names had no initial ***w-/ϝ-***, because Linear A and B faithfully expressed that phoneme. The fact that there is no trace of ***ϝ-*** in ***Ἴδη***, ***Ἴδηθεν***, ***Ἰδαῖος*** in Homer either, proves conclusively that the root ***id-*** of ***Ida***, ***Idaia***, ***Idaios***, ***Idomeneus***, ***Idomeneia*** and ***Idomenios*** is Pre-Hellenic and probably Hurrian ***id-***.

The only sound conclusion is: If Chadwick's and Baumbach's association of ***ἴδη*** and Doric ***ἴδᾱ*** 'forest' with Cretan ***Βίδᾱν*** is correct, two distinct roots may have coexisted, one with and one without initial digamma. The name of mount ***Ida*** (***Ἴδη***) and its cognates ***Idaia***, ***Idaios***, ***Idomeneus***, ***Idomeneia*** and ***Idomenios*** certainly contained *no initial digamma*. Disappearance of the digamma after the time of the Mycenaean Linear B tablets may have caused confusion of the root of the name of mount ***Ida*** with that of the noun ***ἴδη*** (Doric ***ἴδᾱ***) < * ***ϝίδᾱ*** 'timber-tree, wood, forest' in popular etymology.

P. Chaintraine (o.c.) and H.G. Liddell - R. Scott, *A Greek - English lexicon*, Oxford 1961, do not mention a possible original initial digamma in ***ἴδη*** (Doric ***ἴδᾱ***) 'forest', based on Cretan ***Βίδᾱν*** or Dacian ***ῥαθιβίδα***, which may well account for their association of ***ἴδη*** (Doric ***ἴδᾱ***) 'forest' with the name of mount ***Ida***.

I have analysed Linear A ***i-da*** (PK Za 17; ZA 21b.1; ZA 27a.1) as Hurrian ***id=a=Ø*** 'He (the mountain god) thunders' or 'It (the mountain) thunders', consisting of the root ***id-*** + the indicator of intransitivity ***-a-*** + enclitic pronoun as subject indicator 3rd person singular intransitive indicative ***Ø***. Usage of the indicator of intransitivity ***-a-*** requires a meaning in accordance with the intransitive aspect of the verb and at the same time a meaning close to that of the transitive form of the root ***id-*** 'to strike, to hit violently' + the indicators of transitivity ***-i-*** or ***-u/o-*** as can, for instance, be found in Linear A ***i-du-ti*** (HT 104.2-3). Thunder and lightning are not only an expression of divine wrath of the Hurrian supreme god Tešub and his Greek counterpart Zeus, but are also associated with the top of a mountain massif where thunderclouds gather and whence these mountain gods hurl their thunderbolts causing great anxiety among the population.

Linear A ***i-du-ti*** (HT 104.2-3) can probably be interpreted as a Hurrian personal name containing the verbal root ***id-*** 'to beat, hit, smash, strike', cf. e.g. I. Wegner, *Einführung*, 41, 256, s.v. ***id-*** 'schlagen'; Th. Richter, *BGH*, 109-110, s.v. ***id-*** I [Boğ.] and *VHN*, 405, s.v. ***id-*** II, '(zer)schlagen' ['to beat, hit, smash, strike violently']. Semantically Linear A ***i-du-ti*** can be compared with the Hurrian personal name ***Ullutti*** (wr. *ul-lu-ut-ti*) from Mari and Tigunāni, analysis {*o/ull=u=tti*}, lexicon *ull-*, typology 1.3.1.1.2.2, 'Zerstöre mich (oh *Numen*) !', ['Destroy me (oh *numen*) !'], which is considered a variant of the personal name ***Ullutta*** (wr. *ul-lu-ut-ta*) from Šušarrā (Tall Shemshara), analysis {*o/ull=u=tta*}, lexicon *ull-*, typology 1.3.1.1.2.1, also 'Zerstöre mich (oh *Numen*) !', ['Destroy me (oh *numen*) !'], with the *optional allomorphic* enclitic personal pronoun 1st person sing. ***-tti*** instead of ***-tta***, cf. Th. Richter, *VHN*, 329 and 596.

Linear A ***i-da-a*** (KO Za 1.b-c) {*id=a-ya*} '(The) thunderer', following ***a-ta-i-jo-wa-ja , tu-ru-sa , du-pu-re*** (see *sub vocibus*) on a limestone parallelepiped from the Peak Sanctuary of Kophinas, is probably epithet to ***a-ta-i-jo-wa-ja*** (= Hurrian reconstructed ****at-ta-i-iw-wa-(y)aš***) 'Our Father', and equivalent to ***i-da-ja*** (PK Za 18) from Petsophas.

The latter inscription used to be read as]***-te*** **,** ***i-da*** **,** ***ja-ja-***['], but should probably be read as]***-te*** **,** ***i-da-ja*** **,** ***ja-***[**'**] and be completed to ***si-ru***]***-te*** **,** ***i-da-ja*** **,** ***ja-***[***di<da>ki-te-te***.

Linear A ***i-da-a*** (KO Za 1.b-c) and ***i-da-ja*** (PK Za 18) may well be a hypocoristic form (with the Hurrian hypocoristic suffix ***-ya***) of Linear A ***i-da-ma-te*** {*id=am=a-te*} 'Tešub is thundering' or 'Thunder, oh Tešub !' and prototype of Linear B ***i-da-i-jo*** (KN K 875,4; PY An 661,2), probably ***Ἰδαῖος***, probably originally with the same meaning as Linear A ***i-da-a*** {*id=a-ya*}, '(The) thunderer'. As soon as the Mycenaean Greeks did no longer understand the Minoan-Hurrian etymology of the epithet, the meaning changed to 'God of Mount Ida', cf. the usual translation of *Zeus Idaios* 'Zeus of Mount Ida'. Like Linear A ***i-da*** (PK Za 17; ZA 21b.1; ZA 27a.1), the epithets ***i-da-a*** (KO Za 1.b-c), ***i-da-ja*** (PK Za 18) and ***i-da-ma-te*** (AR Zf 1; AR Zf 2) contained the root ***id-*** + the marker of intransitivity ***-a-***. However, ***i-da-ma-te*** also contains the root-extension ***-am-*** between the root and the marker ***-a-***. I. Wegner (*Einführung*, 87-89, sub 5.2.1, Position 1: root-extensions) discusses the so-called 'root-extensions' of the verb, which take the first position in the chain of suffixes, directly following the root. One of these root-extensions is ***-am-*** that expresses the *factitive* aspect of the verb according to G. Wilhelm, *Iraq 53 (1991)*, 12, Anm. 35. I. Wegner offers the example: ***eman-*** 'ten', ***eman=am-***, transitive 'decuple, multiply by ten'; intr. 'increase tenfold'.

If we assume that Linear A ***i-da-ma-te*** contains this root-extension ***-am-***, the analysis will be {*id=am=a-te*}, consisting of the root ***id-*** + root-extension ***-am-*** + the indicator of intransitivity ***-a-*** and the form ***-Te*** (hypocoristic of ***-Tešub***) as subject of the verb: 'Tešub thunders, Tešub causes thunder and lightning'. Or ***-Te(šub)*** is a vocative and ***i-da-ma-te*** can be translated 'Cause thunder and lightning, oh Tešub !'.

Theoretically ***i-da-a*** (KO Za 1.b-c) on a limestone parallelipiped (HM 2627, 1962?) from Mount Kophinas could be interpreted as a Hurrian hypocoristic personal name like, for instance, Linear A ***ki-pa-a*** (KN Zb 1) and ***u-na-a*** (KN Zb 2) on a pithoid jar from Knossos (with the Hurrian hypocoristic suffix ***-ya***) or like King Priam's charioteer ***Ἰδαῖος*** (*Iliad* Γ 248; Ω 325) and like a Trojan ***Ἰδαῖος***, son of Dares, saved by Hephaistos (*Iliad* E 11, 20). I have previously suggested that ***i-da-a*** might in that case be the name or title of a priest 'Priest of Ida' or refer to a supplicant, but since it occurs on the limestone parallelipiped from the Peak Sanctuary of Mount Kophinas and especially since it is the third sequence after ***a-ta-i-jo-wa-ja*** 'Our Father', there can in my view be no doubt that it is indeed an epithet to ***a-ta-i-jo-wa-ja*** and that it has exactly the same function as ***Ἰδαῖος*** has in Homer's ***Ζεὺς Ἰδαῖος***, in the combination ***Διὸς ἱρεὺς Ἰδαίου*** 'priest of Zeus Idaios' (*Iliad* Π 604-605) and in ***κελαινεφέϊ Κρονίωνι Ἰδαίῳ*** 'for the son of Kronos, lord of the dark clouds, god of Ida' (*Iliad* Ω 290-291). Moreover, if ***i-da-a*** (KO Za 1.b-c) were a personal name, it would be strange that virtually the same name, ***i-da-ja*** (PK Za 18), was also found in the Peak Sanctuary of Mount Petsophas (Palaikastro).

In the *Iliad* the epithet ***Ἰδαῖος*** may already have lost the original meaning '(The) thunderer', which Linear A ***i-da-a*** and ***i-da-ja*** {*id=a-ya*} probably still had. This is clear, if we compare *Iliad* Ω 308, where Priam prays to Zeus: *"Ζεῦ πάτερ, Ἴδηθεν μεδέων, κύδιστε μέγιστε", "Father Zeus, that rulest from Ida, most glorious, most great"*. Here we see that ***Ἴδηθεν μεδέων*** *"ruling from Ida"* emphasizes the association of Zeus with Mount Ida, suggesting that ***Ἰδαῖος*** is also to be associated with the mountain.

However, we must not forget that in *Iliad* Ω 290-291, Zeus, the son of Kronos, is not only called ***Ἰδαῖος***, but also 'Lord of the dark clouds'. So the association of Zeus with *thunder and lightning* is never far away. It is also significant that Zeus is called 'Father' in the *vocative* ***Ζεῦ πάτερ*** (*Iliad* Ω 308) in Priam's prayer and that in *Iliad* Θ 31 Athena speaks to him: *"ὦ πάτερ ἡμέτερε Κρονίδη, ὕπατε κρειόντων"*, *"Oh Our Father, thou son of Kronos, high above all lords"*. This reminds us how many Linear A libations formulas start with ***a-ta-i-jo-wa-ja*** (in the *absolutive-vocative*).

Although the absolutive ****at-ta-i-iw-wa-aš*** is not yet attested in cuneiform, the ergative ***at-ta-iw-wa-šu-uš*** is, cf. J. Friedrich, *Kleinasiatische Sprachdenkmäler*, Berlin 1932, 32: ***^{d}Te-e-eš-šu-pa-aš*** … ***ip-ri-iu̯-u̯ə-šu-uš at-ta-iu̯-u̯ə-šu-uš*** (Mit. IV, 118) 'Tešub … Our Lord, Our Father', transliterated as ***ew-ri-iw-wa-šu-uš at-ta-iw-wa-šu-uš*** by E.A. Speiser, *Introduction to Hurrian*, New Haven 1941, 103, § 144, n. 105, and E. Laroche, *Glossaire de la langue hourrite*, Paris 1978-79, reprint 1980, 63. They mention that it is the 1st person of the plural possessive ergative, but do not tell that the only time that Tušratta used this form, it refers to Tešub and that this is the closest parallel between the Hurrian Stormgod and ***eni attanni***. It is interesting that in contrast to this usage of the *plural* possessive 'Our Father', Tušratta uses the *singular* forms 'my father' or 'your father', when he speaks about his own father or that of Amenhotep III respectively, so about people of flesh and blood.

It is time to return to the combination | ***a-ro-te*** ̣ | | ***i-da-da*** | (KT Zg 2a-b) → as read from the seal-impression. Since Linear A syllabic sign ***22*** can be ***lo*** or ***ro***, several interpretations of ***a-ro-te*** (KT Zg 2.a.) are feasible:

1) ***a-ro-te*** can be identified with the Hurrian personal name ****Allu-te***. The Hurrian personal name ***Allu-teia̯*** (wr. *Al-lu-te-e-a*) is attested at Nuzi (JEN 518:10; cf. I.J. Gelb, *NPN*, 20, s.v. ***Allu-teia̯***; P.M. Purves, *NPN*, 199, s.v. ***all***, ***allu-***). Since ***-teia̯*** and ***-te*** are both very common hypocoristic forms of ***-tešup*** in Hurrian theophorous sentence names, ****Allu-te*** is equivalent to ***Allu-teia̯***. Phonologically it is probably /***Allote***/.

According to Th. Richter (*BGH*, 12-14) the verbal root ***all-*** II means 'to rule', cf. Urartian ***alae*** and ***aluse*** 'ruler' and the Urartian root ***al-*** 'to be lord, to rule'. Cf. also Hurrian ***allai*** 'Lady, Mistress' or 'Queen'. If this verbal root is chosen, the whole phrase ***a-ro-te*** ̣ ***i-da-da*** (KT Zg 2.a-b) can be analysed as ***all=o-te ida=dan*** and can be rendered 'Tešub ruled and rules from (Mount) Ida'.

This would again remind us of the Old Hurrian version of Homeric ***Ἴδηθεν μεδέων*** "ruling from Ida" in *Iliad* Ω 308, where Priam prays to Zeus: *"Ζεῦ πάτερ, Ἴδηθεν μεδέων, κύδιστε μέγιστε"*, *"Father Zeus, that rulest from Ida, most glorious, most great"*.

2) Since ***-m-*** preceding an occlusive is not expressed in consonant clusters in Linear A and B, analysis of ***a-ro-te*** as ***all=o=m-te***, consisting of the root ***all-*** + the marker of the Old Hurrian past tense (with durative aspect) ***-o-*** + the Old Hurrian marker of the subject 3rd person singular ***-m*** and the hypocoristic theophorous element ***-te***, is also feasible: 'Tešub, he ruled and rules (from Ida)'. Since there is no object mentioned, we may conclude that the verb is used as an *antipassive*.

3) ***a-ro-te*** can consist of the Hurrian verbal element ***ar=o/u-***, phonologically /***aro***/, and the hypocoristic theophorous element ***-te***.

After publication of the Hurrian-Hittite bilingual ***kirenze*** (KBo 32) it was recognized that many Hurrian personal names probably belong to the category of 'Old Hurrian', cf. I. Wegner, *Einführung*, 125-126 (sub E 'Althurritisch'). She now translates (*Einführung*, 126) ***Tad=o=ḫepa*** as 'Ḫeba loves (namely the bearer of the name)'. She explains that

-i- is the indicator of the transitive verb without aspect,

-u- is the indicator of the transitive verb in the perfect tense,

-a- is the indicator of the intransitive verb,

-o- is the indicator of a state of being or durative aspect of the verbal element in personal names (type of ***Tad=o=Ḫeba***).

According to M.L. Chačikjan (*Churritskij i urartskij jazyki*, Erevan 1985) ***-u-*** signifies the transitive perfect forms and ***-o-*** the durative aspect. However, G. Wilhelm (Zum hurritischen Verbalsystem, in: S.R. Anschütz (ed.), *Texte, Sätze, Wörter und Moneme*, Festschrift für Klaus Heger zum 65. Geburtstag, Heidelberg 1992, 667 ff.), demonstrated that the 'thematic vowel' of the transitive past or perfect tense is not ***-u-***, but ***-o-***, and that the alleged indicator ***-o-*** of the durative aspect in fact represents the same grammeme.

Differentiation between ***-u-*** and ***-o-*** is in this case no longer necessary. I may add: Parents usually hope that the invoked deity will not only take care of a birth without complications, but also of good fortune in the future. So giving a name to a child was, certainly in antiquity, a significant event as the Latin proverb *nomen est omen* shows. As a result the name ^{f}*Taduḫepa* may combine both aspects: birth and future of the child/girl, suggesting 'Ḫeba(t) loved (the girl at birth) and keeps loving (her)'.

In accordance with interpretation of ***Tad=o=Ḫeba***, Linear A ***a-ro-te*** can be analysed as Hurrian ***Ar=o=Te****(šub)* and interpreted as 'Teš(š)ub gave and keeps giving'.

At Nuzi so-called sentence names are attested such as ***Ari-teš(š)up*** (wr. *A-ri-te-šup*), {*ar=i-teš(š)up*}, with transitive imperative ***ar=i-*** + the theophorous element ***-tešup***. At Nuzi one finds at least 52 persons with the name ***Ar-tešup*** (wr. *Ar-te-šup, Ar-te-eš-šup, Ar-te-eš-šu-up, Ar-te-šu-up, A-ar-te-šup, Ar-*^{d}*te-šup*), which probably represents the *athematic* imperative ***ar-*** + ***-tešup***. Also the hypocoristics with ***-te***, ***-teḫa*** or ***-tešše*** 'Give, oh Teš(š)ub !', are quite common: ***Arte*** (wr. *Ar-te-*, *Ar-te-e*), 58 persons with the name ***Ar-teḫa*** (wr. *Ar-te-ia*, *Ar-te-e-a*, *Ar-te-a*, *Ar-ti-ia*, *Ar-di-ia*) and 22 persons with the name ***Ar-tešše*** (wr. *Ar-te-eš-še, Ar-te-še, Ar-teš-še*), cf. I.J. Gelb, *NPN*, 34-35; P.M. Purves, *NPN*, 202-204. Old Hurrian ***Ari-p-tešup*** (wr. *A-ri-ip-te-šup*) is also attested at Nuzi, cf. I.J. Gelb, *NPN*, 29. It can be analysed as {*ar=i=b-tešup*}, with the Old Hurrian indicative 3rd person singular *=i=b*, translation 'Tešub gives'. At Alalaḫ *Arib-Tešubi* (wr. **A-ri-ib-te-eš-šu-bi*, *40:7) and *Ari-Tešub* (wr. **A-ri-*^{d}IM DUB.SAR, *6:33) are attested in level VII (* in the Alalaḫ texts), cf. A. Draffkorn, *HHA*, 24, s.v. *Arib-Tešubi* and *Ari-Tešub*. The latter name is also found at Boğazköy, cf. E. Laroche, *NH*, 38, n° 127, s.v. *Ari-Tešub*.

According to I. Wegner (*Einführung*, 125-127) the suffix ***-b-*** is the Old Hurrian marker of the 3rd person singular of transitive and intransitive verbs of action. For instance, the transitive verb ***pašš-*** 'to send', with the marker of transitivity /***i***/, offers the 'Old Hurrian' form ***pašš=i=b*** 'he sends', because it is also a verb of action, whereas the Tušratta-letter would yield ****pašš=i=a*** 'he sends'. The intransitive verb ***un-*** 'to come', with the marker of intransitivity ***-a-***, offers in 'Old Hurrian' the form ***un=a=b*** 'he comes', because it is also a verb of action, whereas the Tušratta-letter yields ***un=a=(Ø)*** 'he comes'.

Incidentally, the personal suffix ***-b-*** occurs with both singular and plural subjects of the 3rd person. In the latter case the plural indicator fails in the verbal form, but the plurality is indicated by the nominal or pronominal subject, cf. G. Wilhelm ('Zum hurritischen Verbalsystem', in: Festschrift für Klaus Heger, 1992, 662); cf. I. Wegner, *Einführung in die hurritische Sprache*, 127. According to I. Wegner (*ibid.*, 125) 'Old Hurrian' shows morphological features differing from the language of the Tušratta letter, which are also structural according to M.L. Chačikjan, *Churritskij i urarartskij jazyki* (Akademija Nauk Armjanskoj SSR, Institut Vostokovedenija, Churrity i Urarty 2), Erevan 1985. See also *chapter 9: Hurrian Grammar (according to I. Wegner)*.

4) In *Minoan Linear A*, Vol. I: *Hurrians and Hurrian in Minoan Crete* (edition 2016) I suggested that Linear A ***a-ro-te*** could reflect Hurrian ***aruš-te*** {*ar=oz-te*}, semantically and orthographically representing the perfect form of the transitive verb ***ar-***, with the tense marker and Speiser's agent-suffix ***-uš-***, phonologically /***-oz-***/, cf. E.A. Speiser, *IH*, 196, § 225, sub 'suffixes with the verb', perfect ***-oz-***, since according to Linear A and B orthographic conventions ***-s-*** preceding a dental is not expressed in consonant clusters.

An objection to my proposal in the 2016 edition to interpret Linear A ***a-ro-te*** as Hurrian ***Aruš-te*** {*ar=ož-te*} is that the indicator ***-a-*** of the subject of action (position 7 in the chain of suffixes of the indicative, transitive-ergative, positive verb, cf. I. Wegner, *Einführung*, 93, table 4) is missing. The expected form should be {**ar=ož=a-te*} (instead of {**ar=ož-te*}), that can be compared with the personal name ***Arušan*** (wr. *A-ru-ša-an, A-ru-sa-an*) of a *ḫabiru* from Tigunāni and of a soldier from Tuttul (Tall Bi'a), analysis {*ar=ož=a=n(na)*}, typology 1.1.2, translation 'Er/Sie (scil. ein *Numen*) gab ihn (Jungen)' [He/she (scil. a *numen*) gave him (the boy)], cf. Th. Richter, *VHN*, 75. The object 'him' in this name is represented by ***=n***, shortened form of ***=nna***. In his section D on typology and morphology (pp. 584-587), sub 1.1.2, Richter explains that repeatedly, also beyond his *corpus*, 'one-word names' occur that can be described as finite, transitive indicative forms following the example of Mitanni Hurrian (i.e. the vernacular of the Tušratta letter). For the occurrence side by side of 'Old Hurrian' verbal forms and of 'Mitanni Hurrian' formations in contexts he (*VHN*, 584, n. 952) refers to V. Haas - I. Wegner, Beiträge zum hurritischen Lexikon: Die hurritischen Verben *ušš-* "gehen" und *ašš-* "abwaschen, abwischen", in: J. Klinger e. a. (eds.), *Investigationes Anatolicae: Gedenkschrift für Erich Neu* (StBoT 52), Wiesbaden 2010, 109; and S. de Martino, The 'Song of Release' twenty-nine years after its discovery, *Altorientalische Forschungen 39 (2012)*, 209 f.

5) However, Th. Richter (*VHN*, 602) provides s.v. ***Aruš-Ḫeba*** (wr. *a-ru-uš-ḫé-ba*) a form that can be considered parallel to Linear A ***a-ro-te***, interpreted as Hurrian ***Aruš-te***, but the form is analysed in a different way, namely as {*ar=o=ž-Ḫeba*}, and translated '*Ḫeba* möge (Mädchen) geben' ['*Ḫeba* may give (the girl)']. If the theophorous element *-Ḫeba* is exchanged for *-Te*, hypocoristic of *-Teš(š)ub*, the result would be 'May *Teš(š)ub* give (the boy)', quite an acceptable name for a boy.

6) Th. Richter (*VHN*, 593-595), sub 1.3.1.1.1: *Unerweiterte Bildungen* [Unextended formations], mentions that some sentence names can contain an *imperative* in ***º=o*** and a second nominal element in the vocative, e.g.: ***ᶠTalmu-Ḫeba*** at Mari, 'Mache (Mädchen) groß, oh *Ḫeba* !' ['Make (the girl) great, oh *Ḫeba* !'] and ***ᶠUru-Ḫeba*** at Mari, 'Lasse (Mädchen) vorhanden sein, oh *Ḫeba* !' ['Let (the girl) be present, oh *Ḫeba* !'].

As a result Linear A ***a-ro-te*** can be analysed as *imperative* ***ar=o-Te*** 'give, oh *Tešub* !' and the inscription | ***a-ro-te*** ̣ | | ***i-da-da*** | (KT Zg 2a-b) 'give, oh *Tešub* from Ida !'.

We are, of course, accustomed to encounter personal names on the Linear A tablets, but since the inscription | ***a-ro-te*** ̣ | | ***i-da-da*** | occurs on a sealstone, one may choose a real verbal form ***ar=o*** 'give !', combined with the *vocative* 'oh *Tešub* !'. *Tešub* may then grammatically and semantically be connected with the *ablative* ***Ida=dan*** 'from *Ida*'. „Suffixaufnahme" (suffix-reduplication) is not required in the *absolutive-vocative*, since the *absolutive* is an endingless form, cf. I. Wegner, *Einführung*, 70, e.g. *šen(a)=iff=u=ve ašti* (Mit. III 21) 'the woman (*ašti* absolutive singular) of my brother'.

An objection to this interpretation may be that one would expect that in a real sentence the name of *Tešub* would be fully written and not be abbreviated as in a personal name.

On the other hand the frequent occurrence of ***si-ru-te*** on many libation tables shows that the name *Teš(š)ub* can also be abbreviated in standard expressions. Correspondence of Hurrian ***šilu*** with Hurrian ***šilwa*** in personal names (especially in combination with ***-te*** and ***-tešub***) and with Urartian ***silua*** has convinced me that Linear A ***si-lu-te*** is probably equivalent to a Hurrian proverbial expression often at the close of the prayer.

The libation formula turns out to be a prayer addressing Tešub as 'Our Father' in his role of *eni attanni* 'God the Father' and closing off with 'Tešub is good, benevolent' or rather 'be beneficent, oh Tešub !' or (trans.) 'treat (us) well/benevolently, oh Tešub!', which is semantically close to *Kyrie eleison !* in prayers for God's pity and mercy, and close to '*erbarme dich !*' in J.S. Bach's St. Matthew Passion.

However, it is not impossible that ***a-ro-te*** is not a contextual grammatical form, but just a personal name, probably the name of the owner of the sealstone, 'Give (the child), oh *Tešub* !'. The ablative ***Ida=dan*** 'from *Ida*' could then refer to the provenance of this owner. The problem for us is that Hurrian personal names often show the same formations as grammatical forms in context.

7) Th. Richter (*VHN*, 74) also provides s.v. ***Arum-Te*** (wr. *a-ru-um-te*) a perfect 'Old Hurrian' equivalent to Linear A ***a-ro-te***. According to the orthographic conventions of Linear A and B ***-m-*** preceding a dental stop was not expressed in consonant clusters. The name of the *ḫabiru* ***Arum-Te*** from Tigunāni (*Prisma* II 52) is analysed as {*ar=o=m-Te*}, typology 1.1.1.1.1, lexicon *ar-*, *Te (→Teššub)*, and translated as 'Te(ššub) gave (the boy)', since ***-te*** is a frequent hypocoristic form of ***Teš(š)ub*** in personal names. As a matter of fact the full name ***Arum-Teššub*** (wr. *a-rum-te-eš-šu-up*), analysis {*ar=o=m-Teššob*}, typology 1.1.1.1.1, lexicon *ar-*, *Teššub*, and translated as 'Teššub gave (the boy)', is even attested several times: 1 time at Mari (M. 11405: 28); 6 persons marked *ḫabiru* from Tigunāni (*Prisma* II 46; II 48; III 39; IV 8; VI 39; VI 51).

If Linear A ***a-ro-te*** (KT Zg 2.a.) is a personal name, identification as ***Arum-Te*** seems preferable, since it is itself attested in Hurrian cuneiform and corroborated by attestations of ***Arum-Teššub***, though it must be admitted that the other interpretations are possible and in accordance with the orthographic conventions of Linear A and B as well. Due to the ambiguities caused by the orthographic conventions of Linear A and B, we can conclude that the Minoan scribe, who inscribed the sealstone, and the owner of the sealstone knew exactly which grammatical form or personal name was expressed by the inscription, but we have to take all possibilities into account.